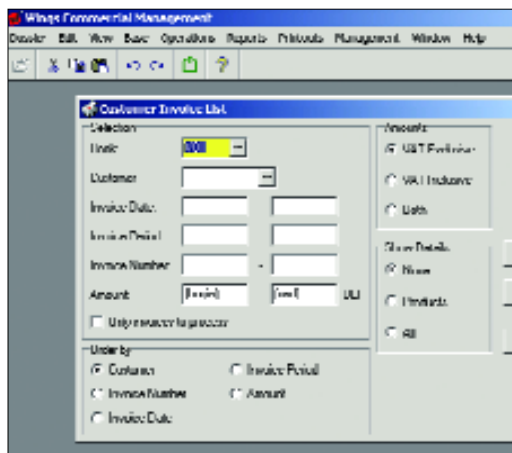




Wings Accounting provides total VAT compatibility

input credit and accounting. It generates all information to help prepare and file returns for VAT. Existing users can easily upgrade to Wings Accounting that is VAT inclusive. Wings Accounting will generate VAT returns directly once the formats are finalised. Wings has special features for NGOs and the apparel and footwear industries. Multi-layered security, report writer, forms and invoice designer, multi-locational accounting, confidential accounting etc. come with Wings Accounting.

Sutinder Singh, director, PCH Marketing, Hyderabad, says, "We have been using Wings Accounting for the last 20 years, starting with the DOS version. Reports can be printed in any format. Wings is web-enabled and can handle large quantities of data. When the Windows version of Wings was introduced, we were apprehensive and switched to Tally for six months. We had to revert to Wings, which is an excellent FA package for SMBs."



Account21

Anyone familiar with the basic accounting system can work comfortably with Account21

Unlike other custom-made accounting software that could be easily tampered with, Tally has rigid security control

Vinod Nair,
Chartered Accountant,
Navi Mumbai

(www.topsyssolutions.com), a Windows-based application. Balagopal Karat of Topsy Solutions, developers and marketers for Account21, says, "It handles billing and inventory control and users can define the format. Certain reports can be e-mailed directly. Account21 has an open interface and data can be imported or exported to and from Excel and CSV." Users can purchase Account21 versions as per the functions of each product—invoicing coupled with multi-currency and/or inventory (for trading/manufacturing).

Vidhya Dhandapani, Accountant, Kropex India Ltd, Bangalore, says, "Account21 is user-friendly with diversification for inventory control. For instance, we deal in 6,000-odd items subject to different rates of taxation. This results in numerous calculations that are now easy to handle thanks to Account 21. It is also VAT-ready, we will just enable that feature once VAT is implemented."



S'Tax

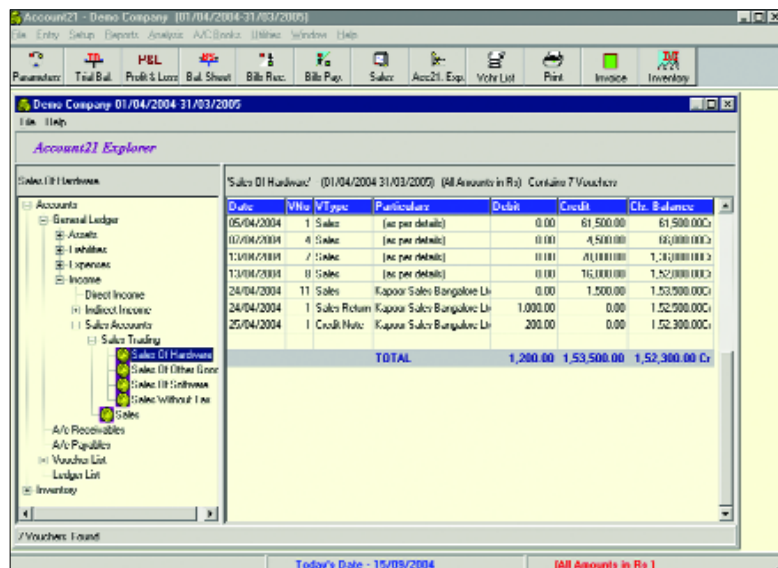
S'Tax (www.sinewave.co.in) is an accounting software used for filing Central Sales Tax (CST) and Maharashtra Sales Tax (MST) monthly, quarterly or annually, depending on the assessee. Priced at Rs 10,000, it includes the various forms required for sales tax payment and offers a standard facility to import data from other software. S'Tax is a product of Sinewave Computer Services Pvt Ltd. Anil Moolani, Director, Sinewave, says, "In a month's time, S'Tax will be equipped with the facility to calculate VAT. Present users of S'Tax can get upgrades that contain VAT modifications, either online or through the CDs we dispatch."

K K Gada, a CA in Mumbai, has been using S'Tax for the last five years. Gada states, "S'Tax efficiently calculates sales tax liability, files returns in the prescribed format, prints challans for tax payment, and so on. S'Tax has made client management easier. Once the modalities of VAT become clear, we will just have to incorporate VAT in some aspects of the accounting procedures (where the amount is to be set off). Other basic accounting principles would remain unaffected. We keep receiving upgrades from Sinewave for S'Tax, Tax Base and even Service Tax. We will simply have to get the upgrade for VAT."

The Last Word

Download a fully-functional demo version of the FA software from the vendor's Web site, or get it totally free on request. This allows you to test the functionality before buying. Steer clear of pirated versions that may contain viruses or have inadequate documentation. Also, users of pirated software are ineligible for technical support and upgrades. While upgrades are not an issue, after-sales service could be a sore point in some cases. However, registered users can obtain online technical help from the call centre of the vendor. The verdict: SMB users of FA software seem to be a contented lot, albeit after some experimentation. ■

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Account 21 is easy to use and has a diversification for inventory control